

12th Grade Independent Research Project

Podcast



Project Overview

In this project you will be required to conduct research on a topic of your choice. The main and final product will be a (1) **podcast** that presents your findings in an engaging and meaningful way. In addition to the podcast, you will submit a (2) **written component** that includes your research documentation and a synopsis of the main issues discussed in the podcast. The written part should cover **three different aspects** of the chosen topic, with a short introduction and conclusion. You will conclude by adding your written reflection on the process, addressing guiding questions.

Step-by-Step Instructions

1. Topic Selection

- Choose a topic that interests you and is broad enough to explore but specific enough to cover in detail.
- Ensure that the topic is researchable and **has sufficient resources available** (articles, books, interviews, etc.).

2. Formulate Your Research Questions

- a) **Develop a clear and focused research question that will guide your project.** This main research question should be open-ended and encourage deep exploration of your topic.

Example: "How has social media influenced political activism among young people during the Russia-Ukraine war?"

- b) **Divide your main research topic into three different aspects, and develop meaningful research questions for each of them.** These will be your three “chapters” of the project, three issues you need to address in your podcast. Note that, when combined, these three aspects should provide an answer to the main research question.

Example:

Aspect 1 - Raising political awareness: “How has social media informed young people about the political and humanitarian dimensions of the Russia-Ukraine war?”

Aspect 2 - Social Media as a Tool for Political Activism: “In what ways has social media provided a platform for political activism among young people during the Russia-Ukraine war?”

Aspect 3 - Impact on real-world politics: “What is the relationship between social media activism and offline political participation among young people in the context of the Russia-Ukraine war?”

3. Conduct Research

- Use a variety of sources (books, academic articles, credible websites, interviews, etc.) to gather information related to your research question.
- Keep track of your sources (!) and take detailed notes to ensure that your podcast is well-informed and accurate. **Note** that you are required to mention your sources in the podcast as well.

4. Develop a Podcast Outline (NOT handed in)

- Break down your podcast into three main sections, each addressing a key aspect of your research topic. (corresponding with your 3 “mini” research questions)
- Plan how you will present your findings in a way that is both informative and engaging for your audience.
- Edit your script and divide the rolls between the group-members.

Note! Everyone must participate as equally as possible in the podcast itself.

5. Research work - Written component (50 pts) + Individual short presentation (50 pts)

As mentioned, this part needs to be submitted alongside your podcast, but is graded separately. It is also a part of your הגשה grade for module G.

The written synopsis should be clear and organized, in a neatly formatted document.

- **Introduction (½ a page):** Provide an overview of your topic and research question. Explain the relevance of the topic and why it is important to explore. This is where you also state your main research question.
- **“Body” of your written component** (should correspond with your podcast):
 - **Address each aspect separately (3 mini-essays, ½ a page each).** In each part, state the relevant research question.
 - Shortly analyze each aspect, providing evidence, examples, and highlighting unique and interesting insights you discovered.
- **Conclusion (½ a page):** Summarize the key points from the three aspects and answer your research question. Discuss the broader implications of your findings and suggest possible further research.
- Source list (according to the guidelines below).
- **Reflection (½ a page each):** Written by each team-member separately (guiding questions below).
- After submitting, each student would speak to me for several minutes, introducing the group’s research and answering questions about it.

6. Produce the Podcast (100 pts)

This is the main part of your work, and will therefore have a bigger impact on your report card. It is also a part of your הגשה grade for the COBE.

- Record your podcast based on the outline you developed (item 4).
- Edit the audio to ensure clarity, pacing, and engagement. Consider the use of sound effects, music, transitions, interviews, and other audio elements to enhance your podcast. **Note: The podcast should be 10-15 minutes long and should present your research in a compelling way.**

7. Submit the Final Project

- **Podcast Submission:** Upload your recording to your Google-Drive, then share only the link with me. Make sure you grant access to anyone with the link.
 - **Written Component:** Submit this part either as a word document or Google-Doc (if you do, make sure it is open for editing before sharing the link with me).
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Assessment Criteria (each parameter will be reduced if criteria aren't fully met)

- **Written Component + Individual short presentation:**

(10 pts) ○ **Research Question Quality:** Clarity, focus, and relevance of the research question.

○ Clarity, organization, language accuracy (including grammar, syntax, punctuation, mechanics), and depth of analysis:

(10 pts each) Introduction, three aspects, and conclusion.

(10 pts) ○ **Reflection:** Insightfulness and honesty in the reflection on the research process.

(30 pts) ○ **A short interview with me:** Being able to describe the different parts of the research in short and answer questions about the process.

- **Podcast:**

(40 pts) ○ **Podcast Quality:** Clarity, speech fluency, engagement, structure, language accuracy.

(40 pts) ○ **Depth of Research:** Thoroughness and diversity of sources used throughout the podcast, as well as accuracy and credibility of information.

(10 pts) ○ **Creativity and Originality:** Presentation of the podcast and the overall approach to the project, as well as use of audio elements.

(10 pts) ○ Technical quality: Sound quality of the podcast.

Steps:

1. Project introduction in class, division to teams, topic selection and research question formulation.
 2. Conduct preliminary research and take detailed notes.
 3. Develop podcast outline and write the first draft of the synopsis (written part).
 4. Record and edit the podcast.
 5. Finalize the podcast and written component.
 6. **Final due date** - Submit the project: **12.12.25** (might move slightly)
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Tools and Resources:

- **Recording Equipment:** Microphone, audio recording software (e.g., Audacity, GarageBand).
- **Editing Software:** Audio editing tools for polishing your podcast.
- **Research Tools:** Online databases, library resources, interview guides, AI tools**

*** Will be discussed in class, using those tools must be done in a meaningful way, focusing your search for sources, refining your prompts to articulate your research question etc.*

Using AI tools to write/record your project might result in disqualification of your project.

Bibliographical Entries - MLA Form (citing sources in your project is MANDATORY!)

- **For a book.**

Author's last name, First initial, *Title of book in italics*. Publishing company, Publication year.
Lowry, L, *The Giver*. Houghton Mifflin, 1993.

- **For an article.**

Author's last name, First initial, *Title of article in italics*. name of journal, Volume, Publication year, pages.
Smith, F, *The bees in Israel*. Israeli Journal of Wildlife. Vol 11, 2001, pp 61-84.

- **For a Web Page.**

Author's last name. First initial or Organization's name, Publication date, *Title of Web Page in italics*. Full Internet address

Klein-Leichman, A. *How Israel swims against tide of worldwide water crisis*, 2019.
<https://www.israel21c.org/how-israel-swims-against-tide-of-worldwide-water-crisis/>

Reflection

*** **Note!** The reflection should be written fluently, in the form of an essay, and not in bullets. Most of these items below need to be addressed, but not answered as a list of questions.

1. Which parts of the project were you responsible for? (in case you divided the work)
 2. What did you like best about working on this project? What did you dislike? Explain.
 3. If you could redo the project, what would you do differently?
 4. What aspect of the project was most difficult for you? What was easiest? Explain.
 5. Has working on this project made you a more independent learner / more responsible for your learning / more confident in yourself / more organized?
 6. In what areas has the project helped your English improve? (language skills)
 7. In your opinion, what were the advantages/disadvantages of group work?
 8. How did AI engines assist in the project? In which phases of work did you use them?
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Feel free to ask any questions or request additional guidance at any stage of the project.

Good Luck & Enjoy!

